CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 13

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Read the following message.

Dear Mrs. Smith,

I am writing in response to your reservation request for the "Blue Oasis" vacation property. I sincerely appreciate your choosing my rental property for your family's Christmas holidays; however, I regret to inform you that the home you've chosen has already been booked. The good news is that in the same neighbourhood I own another property which is larger - "Seaside Escape." It has a pool and is desirably situated closer to the ocean. I think this house would be an excellent choice for a family with kids, such as yours, as the amenities include high speed wireless internet, video game consoles, and a four-player table tennis set, not to mention a home theatre system. Although I usually rent it at a higher rate than the slightly less roomy "Blue Oasis," I am willing to offer it to you for the same price.

The available house is more spacious and luxurious than your original choice. This three-level villa offers a total of 4 bedrooms and 4 bathrooms that are spread out over two floors and can sleep up to 8 people comfortably. On the main level is a large living room and a formal dining room off the open gourmet kitchen. Beside the kitchen is a recreation room and a separate entertainment room with a large-screen TV. There is also a stunning outdoor pool which has a waterfall on one side and is completely surrounded by tropical landscaping to maintain privacy. Just off the pool is a large seating area with an outside shower and a large barbecue. The home's wrap-around decks overlook the elegant pool, ocean and dock. There are also many other attractions in the neighborhood, such as restaurants, movie theatres, an amusement park, and a shopping mall.

If you are interested in taking me up on this offer, please let me know by September 21st. As previously mentioned, I am willing to rent you this property for a reduced rate of $1200 a week. Please be advised that a $450 deposit must be made at the time of the reservation, and the remainder must be paid by October 31st.

I look forward to hearing from you regarding your decision.

Sincerely,

Sandro Cavalli

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. What kind of letter is this?
- ◯ offer
- ◯ advice
- ◯ apology
- ◯ agreement

2. Who is Mr. Cavalli?
- ◯ a seller
- ◯ a parent
- ◯ an agent
- ◯ a landlord

3. "Blue Oasis" is _____
- ◯ taken.
- ◯ sold.
- ◯ roomy.
- ◯ vacant.

4. Compared to Blue Oasis, "Seaside Escape" has _____
- ◯ more flexible payment terms.
- ◯ more convenient beach access.
- ◯ higher quality kitchen appliances.
- ◯ fewer entertainment options.

5. What does Sandro suggest the children will enjoy?
- ◯ the gourmet kitchen
- ◯ mall shopping
- ◯ game playing
- ◯ outdoor swimming

6. Four hundred and fifty dollars is to... _____
- ◯ cover travel costs.
- ◯ confirm the booking.
- ◯ pay for damages.
- ◯ finalize the payment.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Dear Mr. Cavalli,

Many thanks for your message concerning the alternate property. You've given me a thorough 7. _____ of the residence, which, on one level at least, would seem an appealing substitute for my own more 8. _____ initial selection. Obviously your pricing is 9. _____ compared with Seaside Escape. However, I do have two concerns to address before I'm ready to 10. _____ . I understand this is a multi-storey house and that it has a pool, both of which seem to be considered 11. _____ features. That said, I have a one-year-old child and am wondering if there are stairway safety gates and a pool enclosure. Could you advise?

Kind regards,
Olean Smith

7. ◯ apology
   ◯ confirmation
   ◯ description
   ◯ contract

8. ◯ modest
   ◯ private
   ◯ coastal
   ◯ expensive

9. ◯ complex
   ◯ favourable
   ◯ standard
   ◯ inflexible

10. ◯ move
    ◯ buy
    ◯ bid
    ◯ choose

11. ◯ exotic
    ◯ brand-new
    ◯ desirable
    ◯ unusual

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Menu	*ABC Annual Sales Conference*
	Cream of Asparagus Soup • Thick and delicious, with a rich, creamy flavour and a hint of lemon • Your choice of either soda crackers, bread, or tortilla chips as a side • Winner of the Chef's Choice Award three years in a row
	Fresh Mediterranean Salad • Fresh garden vegetables, flavourful black olives, rich feta cheese, and crunchy walnuts • Drizzled with our special white wine vinaigrette, made with wine from some of the top vineyards in the country • All produce is organic and locally grown
	Deluxe Wrap Served with Crispy Fries • Your choice of vegetarian, chicken, beef, or pork • Loaded with fresh vegetables (lettuce, onions, cucumber, cabbage) and our signature roasted red pepper mayo • Wraps are available in white, whole wheat, and multigrain; choice of grilled or baked • You may opt for yam fries, chickpea fries, soup, or a garden salad at no extra charge • Vegan option available
	Tasty Treats for Dessert • A variety of tarts, pies, squares, and cakes • All desserts come with your choice of fresh berries (strawberries, blueberries, or raspberries) and iced cream (vanilla, chocolate, or butterscotch) • All desserts are made daily in-house
Note: Gluten free ingredients and smaller portions of all menu items are available upon request. Please notify staff of any food allergies.	

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

Subject: Are you free for lunch?
To: Alina Lee <alinal22@xmail.ca>
From: Janet Foster <jfoster@xmail.ca>

Hey Alina,

How are you enjoying the 1. _____ so far? Listen, since you're going to be 2. _____ because of your presentation, I can order lunch for you and save you a seat at our table. Management wants us to meet up with our teams at lunch to discuss the morning workshops. I saw the 3. _____ when I passed the dining hall this morning. The selections sound pretty good. There's cream of asparagus soup or 4. _____ to start. For the main course, there's a wrap. Which would you prefer: vegetarian, chicken, beef, or pork? They all come with fresh veggies and 5. _____ with your choice of side. There are some really interesting desserts as well. I know sweets aren't your cup of tea, but they come with fresh berries and look delicious.

Let me know, and I'll see you at lunch,

Janet

1. ◯ workshop
   ◯ conference
   ◯ presentation
   ◯ celebration

2. ◯ leaving early
   ◯ meeting new people
   ◯ late for lunch
   ◯ sharing your ideas

3. ◯ menu
   ◯ schedule
   ◯ recipes
   ◯ advertisement

4. ◯ chicken wraps
   ◯ french fries
   ◯ lettuce and tomatoes
   ◯ Mediterranean salad

5. ◯ black olives
   ◯ roasted red pepper mayo
   ◯ a hint of lemon
   ◯ white wine vinaigrette

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. Janet and Alina know each other because _____

- ◯ Janet is Alina's boss.
- ◯ they are both managers.
- ◯ they met at the morning workshop.
- ◯ they work together.

7. Janet and Alina are planning to eat lunch together to _____

- ◯ share what they learned.
- ◯ decide which workshops to attend.
- ◯ present topics from the conference.
- ◯ introduce ideas to management.

8. When Janet says that sweets are not Alina's "cup of tea," she means that Alina _____

- ◯ prefers tea to sweets.
- ◯ likes tea with her desserts.
- ◯ doesn't usually like dessert.
- ◯ only likes fresh desserts.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 3

Read the following passage.

A. Regarded as a work of human creative genius, the Rideau Canal is designated as a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a National Historic Site of Canada. Stretching over 202 km from Ottawa to Kingston, it is North America's oldest, continuously operated canal system. The overall design involves a series of 52 dams that control the water levels, and 47 stone locks that allow watercraft to pass through a series of enclosures containing different levels of water. Remarkably, these locks work much the same way today as they did when it originally opened.

B. The motivation for the canal's construction came from a need for defense. At the time, the St. Lawrence River served as the primary supply line for the British colony. However, following the War of 1812 against the Americans, the British loyalists recognized the vulnerability of the St. Lawrence to American attack. In 1826, Lieutenant Colonel John By of Britain's Royal Engineers was tasked with designing a navigable waterway that could serve as a secure military supply route between Montreal and Kingston. The project posed severe logistical and engineering challenges since the desired route consisted of virgin forest, rocky terrain, and untouched rivers and lakes.

C. The construction began in 1826. Independent contractors were in charge of building the waterway, while the Royal Engineers oversaw its design. The skilled work was done primarily by French Canadians, including stonemasons, blacksmiths, and carpenters. The unskilled labour was carried out by immigrants, mainly from Ireland. Over the years, thousands of labourers were involved in the canal's construction. The vast majority of the work was done manually, with some assistance from draft animals. The excavation was done using shovels, axes, and wheelbarrows. Even the large stones of the locks were set in place using manual cranes. The canal was completed in November 1831 and officially opened in 1832.

D. Although the canal was never used for its intended purpose, it was a commercial success. It became a path for early settlement and a supply route for local resources such as lumber, grains, minerals, and farming products. Presently, the canal functions chiefly as a waterway for leisure craft and recreation. The scenic location offers entertainment for every season including dining, museums, fishing, cycling, hiking, canoeing, snowshoeing, skiing, and skating. In the winter, a 7.8 km section is transformed into the world's longest skating rink. The Rideau Canal is popular with tourists and locals alike due to its rich history and variety of attractions.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. Work that required little training was done mostly by settlers.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. The Rideau Canal project spanned several years.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. The plan for the canal arose from the need for greater protection.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. The Rideau Canal has year-round appeal.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. Special devices allow boats to travel through different levels of water on the canal.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. Colonel John By managed the canal construction project from Montreal.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. Businesses in nearby communities profited from the canal's construction.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. The bulk of the work on the canal was carried out by hand.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Military goods were never actually transported along the canal.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

Valhalla Air is continuing to fly its Fortuna 3000 Intercontinental jet, touted by the airline's CEO Goran Pekarchuk as "the world's best commercial aircraft," despite its having been grounded in 2014 after several engine failures. For still-unknown reasons, the turbine engine's ultra-lightweight carbon fibre blades crack and break in midflight. This disrupts engine flow and requires engine shutdown. Some suspect that the company responsible for manufacturing these parts, Mexico's Power Tech Corporation, is trying to save time and cut costs at the expense of quality.

Racing against European rival Nimbus Air to bring its new product to the skies, the 3000's manufacturer, Fortuna Aeronautics, hastily reinforced the blades on affected aircraft; conducted quick, semi-scientific tests convincing the US Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) the blade was safe; and acquired that regulator's approval to re-launch the 3000. This all occurred before the National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) had finished its incident investigation. The NTSB responded with a stern letter urging more guidance from independent experts and more stringent and standardized verification procedures for aircraft components.

Despite the band-aid solution, the 3000 Intercontinental is applauded by environmentalists like Eveline Ryall, who praises its enhanced fuel efficiency and reduced carbon emissions. "In a world where three to six percent of greenhouse gases come from jet exhaust, the 3000 Intercontinental is a step in the right direction."

Interviewed London-Toronto passengers, like Hamida Barzun, gushed over the 3000's in-flight entertainment system and interior design while dismissing safety concerns. "If there were problems, Transport Canada would have intervened."

Valhalla Air has welcomed the latest addition to its fleet with an extravagant marketing campaign. In one video, First Officer Andre Pierre says 3000 Intercontinental passengers "just go, Wow." ("They'll say the same thing when flames start shooting from the turbines over the Atlantic," quipped the Globe and Mail's Sheldon Blumfeld, who lambasted the ads and dubbed the Fortuna aircraft "the Misfortuna.")

Marketing professor Caitlin Harwood labels the 3000 Intercontinental "a flawed product, flawlessly marketed." She notes how Valhalla Air's videos shrewdly ignore overseas outsourcing while emphasizing its made-in-Canada components. "It's a case study in the triumph of marketing over matter."

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. Whose opinion is similar to Sheldon Blumfeld's?

- ◯ Caitlin Harwood
- ◯ Eveline Ryall
- ◯ Goran Pekarchuk
- ◯ Hamida Barzun

2. What did Fortuna do to stay competitive?

- ◯ gained the confidence of the Transportation Safety Board
- ◯ launched an aggressive response to adversity
- ◯ prevented turbine engine failures aboard new aircraft
- ◯ standardized quality control testing of outsourced components

3. Fortuna benefited most from its relationship with _____

- ◯ the Federal Aviation Administration.
- ◯ the Globe and Mail media.
- ◯ the Nimbus Company.
- ◯ the Power Tech Corporation.

4. We can reasonably conclude that _____

- ◯ Fortuna collaborated with its regulators.
- ◯ Nimbus Air produces safer jetliners.
- ◯ Power Tech Corporation was negligent.
- ◯ Valhalla Air flies only 3000s.

5. The best title for this article would be "The Fortuna 3000 Intercontinental: _____

- ◯ Better Than Airworthy, Claims FAA."
- ◯ Faulty Engine Still Puzzles Experts."
- ◯ Marketing Dream, Safety Nightmare."
- ◯ New Technology Cuts Carbon Emissions."

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

This is clearly a tale of 6. _____ . The situation could have been avoided if 7. _____ . The government should require Fortuna to be more 8. _____ . Now I hear a number of Asian aircraft companies are demanding compensation for mechanical problems with the 3000s that they purchased, and these are problems that go beyond the 9. _____ -related ones the writer describes. But I honestly can't see Transport Canada taking any action that might wreak havoc with the profits of one of the country's largest corporations. Valhalla Air had a flotilla of 3000s on order from Fortuna in 2014, and it's no surprise their 10. _____ as they hyped the plane while remaining, along with Transport Canada, shrewdly silent on its many defects.

6. ◯ a corporation showing disregard for due process
   ◯ a regulator operating independently from a business
   ◯ an authority ignoring binding recommendations
   ◯ an investigation being hampered by a journalist

7. ◯ consumers had been given more safety reassurances
   ◯ designers of European jets had been consulted
   ◯ manufacturers had known more about marketing
   ◯ regulators had been forced to act in the public's interest

8. ◯ accessible
   ◯ accountable
   ◯ fuel-conscious
   ◯ scientific

9. ◯ electrical
   ◯ landing
   ◯ navigation
   ◯ propulsion

10. ◯ entire fleet improved
    ◯ federal regulator erred
    ◯ marketing plan tanked
    ◯ share prices soared

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	offer
Question 2	a landlord
Question 3	taken.
Question 4	more convenient beach access.
Question 5	game playing
Question 6	confirm the booking.
Question 7	description
Question 8	modest
Question 9	favourable
Question 10	choose
Question 11	desirable

PART 2	
Question 1	conference
Question 2	late for lunch
Question 3	menu
Question 4	Mediterranean salad
Question 5	roasted red pepper mayo
Question 6	they work together.
Question 7	ishare what they learned.
Question 8	doesn't usually like dessert.

PART 3	
Question 1	C
Question 2	C
Question 3	B
Question 4	D
Question 5	A
Question 6	E
Question 7	E
Question 8	C
Question 9	D

PART 4	
Question 1	Caitlin Harwood
Question 2	launched an aggressive response to adversity
Question 3	the Federal Aviation Administration.
Question 4	Power Tech Corporation was negligent.
Question 5	Marketing Dream, Safety Nightmare."
Question 6	a corporation showing disregard for due process
Question 7	regulators had been forced to act in the public's interest
Question 8	accountable
Question 9	propulsion
Question 10	share prices soared

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